AI Trade Tracker

Monthly U.S. imports of the products used to build and run AI data centers

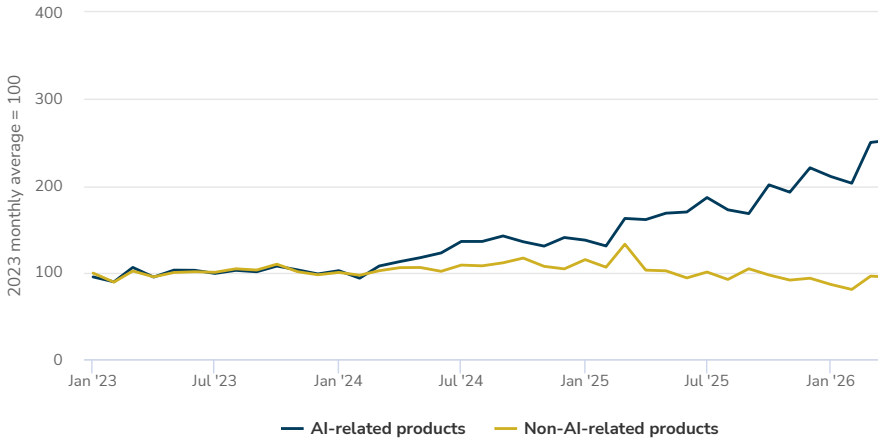
The AI Trade Tracker measures U.S. imports of products related to the construction and operation of AI data center infrastructure. It uses a large language model classifier to assign a relevance to AI infrastructure (high, medium, or low) and a functional category to each of the roughly 18,000 10-digit Harmonized System (HS10) commodity codes in U.S. Census Bureau trade data. The indicator reports monthly import values, an index (2023 = 100), and effective tariff rates for AI-related products, non-AI-related products, and seven AI subcategories: Compute Hardware, Electrical Power, Networking/Telecom, Cooling/HVAC, Building Structure, Fire Safety/Security, and Specialty Materials.

For more information about the AI Trade Tracker, visit Trade War Tracker.

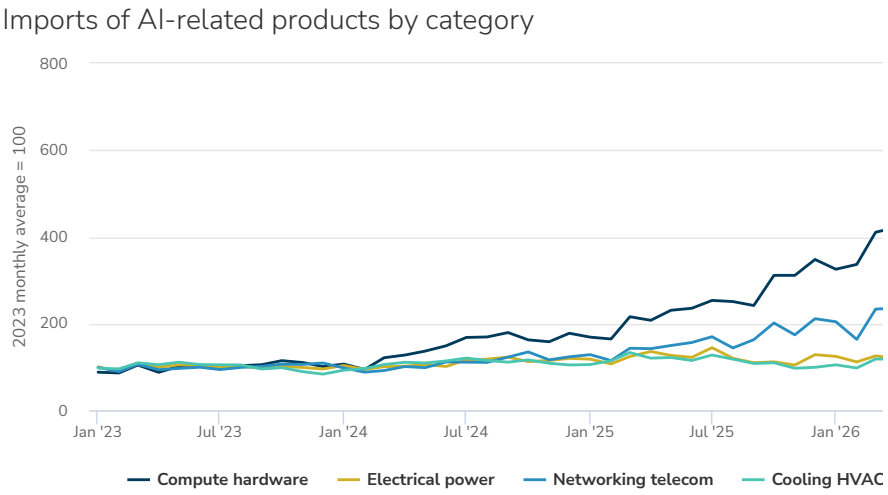
Latest update: November 5, 2026

Update notes: Files will be updated monthly, typically the first week of each month.

U.S. imports of AI-related vs. non-AI-related products



Note: AI-related products are HS10 codes classified as highly relevant to AI data center construction and operation b based classifier; non-AI-related products are codes classified as low relevance. Index = monthly imports relative to t monthly average. Excludes HS chapters 27, 71, 98, and 99. Not seasonally adjusted.
Sources: U.S. Census Bureau; author's calculations.



Note: AI-related products are HS10 codes classified as highly relevant to AI data center construction and operation b based classifier; non-AI-related products are codes classified as low relevance. Index = monthly imports relative to t monthly average. Excludes HS chapters 27, 71, 98, and 99. Not seasonally adjusted.
Sources: U.S. Census Bureau; author's calculations.

The purpose of the indicator is to make the trade side of the AI investment boom visible in near-real time. The data help answer questions such as, How fast are imports of AI-related products growing relative to imports of everything else? Which components (chips and servers versus power and cooling equipment) are driving that growth? How are tariffs affecting AI-related products relative to other goods?

AI-related capital goods are a large and growing share of U.S. imports, so they matter for interpreting headline trade and GDP data and for understanding the trade deficit. The indicator also helps separate the AI investment boom from tariff-driven changes in trade, since AI-related products have faced substantially lower effective tariff rates than other goods. Finally, the AI Trade Tracker provides a timely, product-level read on the pace of data center investment, a key driver of business investment and of the outlook for productivity.

Data downloads

- Download the data **here**.
- Code, slides, and technical documentation are available **here**.

Suggested citation

Waugh, Michael. 2026. "**Trade in AI-Related Products**." *Quarterly Review* 46 (1).

Related content

Research paper

Waugh, Michael. 2026. "**Trade in AI-Related Products**." *Quarterly Review* 46 (1).

Article

Horwich, Jeff. 2026. "**Much More than Microchips: Trade Soars in AI-Related Goods, Driving U.S. Trade Deficit**." Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis.

Contact

Michael Waugh: **michael.waugh@mpls.frb.org**

*This work is licensed under **Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial 4.0 International**.*